Be a Word Architect

Vocabulary Words

curriculum	**mortal**
cursive	**mortality**
excursion	**occurrence**
immortal	**periscope**
immortality	**recurring**
kaleidoscope	**stethoscope**
microscopic	**telescopic**
microwave	

Word Learning Tip!

You can learn the meaning of some long words by looking at the smaller parts that make up the big word. One of these word parts is the root. A root can appear at the beginning, middle, or end of a complete word. If you know the meaning of the root, you have a clue to the meaning of the whole word.

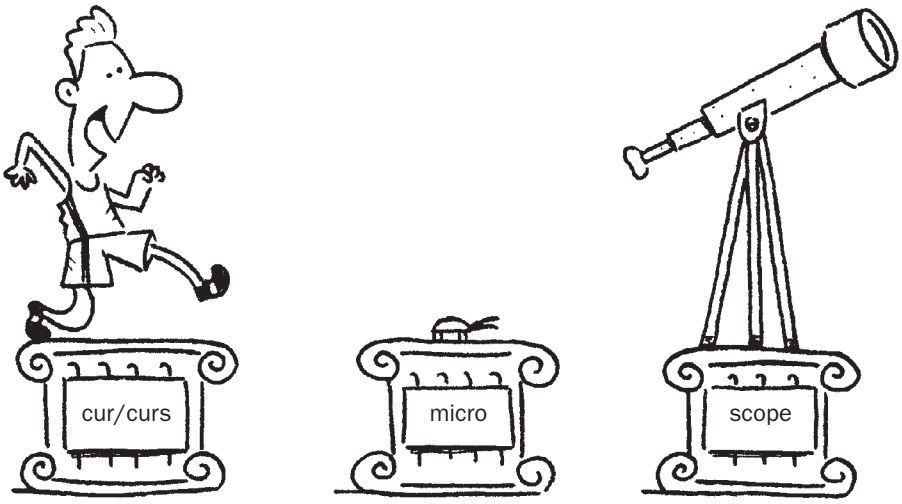
Vocabulary Building Strategy

Use Roots A root is a word part that carries a word's most important meaning. A root cannot stand by itself as a word. It needs a prefix, suffix, or another root or word added to it. Add the meaning of the root together with the meanings of any prefixes, suffixes, or other roots. All words with the same roots will have related meanings.

Learn More!

Many word roots come from the Latin or Greek languages. Understanding word roots is a powerful tool for determining the meaning of an unfamiliar word. When you see a word with the root *cur* or *curs* (different spellings for the same root), you know that the word has something to do with running. *Micro* tells you that the meaning has something to do with smallness. All words built from the root *mort* tell about death, and all words built from the root *scope* deal with seeing or watching.

Root	Meaning
cur/curs	run, running
micro	small
mort	death
scope	see, watch



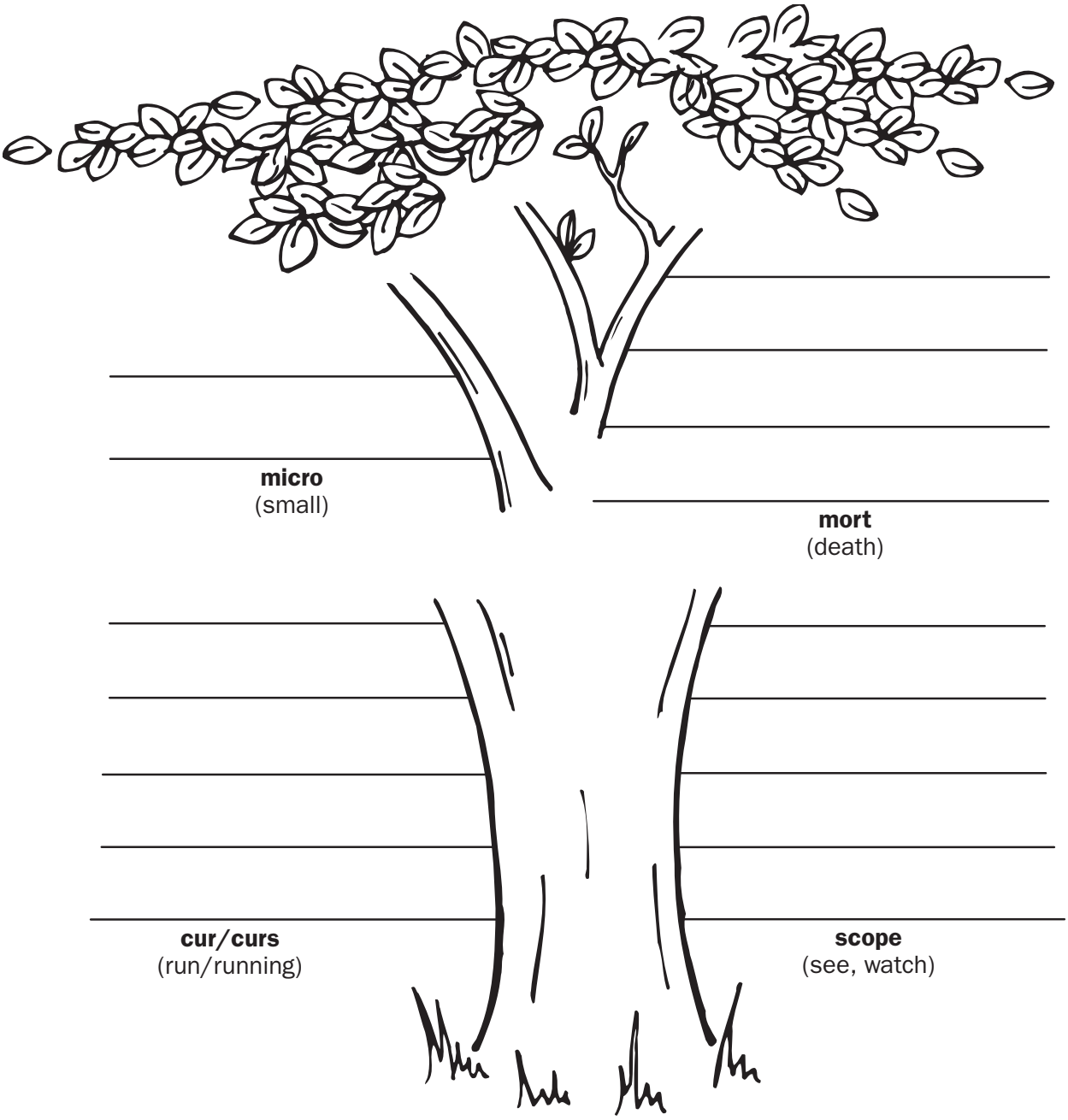
Get to the Root of the Matter Many important words contain the *cur/curs* root. See if you can determine the meaning of these words: *incur, cursory, discursive, current.* Check your meanings in a dictionary.

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Be a Word Architect

curriculum	**immortal**	**microscopic**	**mortality**	**recurring**
cursive	**immortality**	**microwave**	**occurrence**	**stethoscope**
excursion	**kaleidoscope**	**mortal**	**periscope**	**telescopic**

Directions Look at each branch of the root tree below. Place each vocabulary word in the blank on the correct branch. Circle the root in each word. (Hint: One word fits on two different branches.)



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Connect Words and Meanings

curriculum	**immortal**	**microscopic**	**mortality**	**recurring**
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excursion	**kaleidoscope**	**mortal**	**periscope**	**telescopic**

Directions Read each definition below. Then answer each question with a sentence that uses the boldface word. Write your answers on the lines.

1. **immortal** not subject to death; living or lasting forever
How can a poet make someone **immortal**?

2. **microscopic** too small to be seen by the eye alone or very small
How can doctors study **microscopic** germs?

3. **recurring** happening over and over
What type of dream is a **recurring** dream?

4. **mortal** capable of causing death; not living or lasting forever
What happens if a soldier receives a **mortal** wound?

5. **stethoscope** a medical instrument used to listen to sounds from the heart, lungs, and other areas of the body
What can a doctor learn from listening to your chest with a **stethoscope**?

6. **kaleidoscope** a tube in which glass and mirrors create patterns of color and light; a constantly changing set of colors
Why might it be fun to look through a **kaleidoscope**?

7. **immortality** unending life or fame
Why do you think that long ago people searched for the fountain of youth, believing it would bring them **immortality**?

8. **excursion** a trip away from home; a short journey in which you do a lot of running around
What is one **excursion** that you would like to make this year?

Continued on next page

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Connect More Words and Meanings

curriculum	**immortal**	**microscopic**	**mortality**	**recurring**
cursive	**immortality**	**microwave**	**occurrence**	**stethoscope**
excursion	**kaleidoscope**	**mortal**	**periscope**	**telescopic**

Directions Continue this activity. Read each definition below. Then answer the question that follows each definition. Write your answers on the lines.

9. **periscope** an instrument in the shape of a tube with prisms and mirrors that allows you to see someone or something that is far above you
Why would you find a **periscope** on a submarine?

_____

10. **cursive** a form of handwriting in which each letter runs into or is joined to the next letter
Do you like to write in **cursive** or do you prefer to print? Explain why.

_____

11. **curriculum** a group of courses of study that are connected
What part of the **curriculum** for your grade is your favorite? Explain why.

_____

12. **telescopic** able to see great distances; relating to a telescope—an instrument that allows you to see objects that are very far away
When would you use a **telescopic** lens on a camera?

_____

13. **occurrence** an event; something that takes place
What everyday **occurrence**, such as the sunset, do you enjoy most?

_____

14. **microwave** an electromagnetic wave that can pass through solid objects; an oven that cooks very quickly by using this type of wave
When would you use a **microwave** instead of a regular oven?

_____

15. **mortality** the condition of being a creature that can die
When scientists study the spread of a disease, why do they keep track of **mortality** rates?

_____

Write a Sentence Choose three of your vocabulary words. In your personal word journal, write a sentence that uses all three words. If you can't use three words, try for two in one sentence or include another word with one of the roots taught in this lesson.

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Learn Words in Context

curriculum	immortal	microscopic	mortality	recurring
cursive	immortality	microwave	occurrence	stethoscope
excursion	kaleidoscope	mortal	periscope	telescopic

Off to Egypt!

"Let's take an **excursion** to the Museum of Natural History," Rebecca said. "Sounds like a great trip to me," Charles replied. "Especially since ancient Egypt is part of our history **curriculum** this year."

First, the pair looked at the Egyptian mummies. "Like all human beings, the Egyptians were **mortal**," said the guide. "But the ancient Egyptian kings, or pharaohs, wanted to be **immortal**. They had their bodies preserved in treated cloth and buried in huge stone monuments called pyramids. They could not overcome their physical **mortality**, but they did achieve a kind of **immortality** since we still remember them today."

"Look at the writing on those ancient stones," said Rebecca. "It is not like the **cursive** writing we use. I see **recurring** patterns in many of the symbols and pictures. Some parts of the pictures are almost **microscopic**. They may not have been that small to start with. They probably faded or crumbled away over the centuries."

"Unfortunately," the guide continued, "breaking into the pyramids has been a common **occurrence** and many valuable objects and works of art have been lost or stolen."

At the gift shop, Charles looked through a **kaleidoscope**. "What beautiful patterns it makes!" he said. Rebecca saw a **stethoscope** that was part of a junior doctor kit. There was also a toy submarine with a **periscope** that rotated in a complete circle. "I want a **telescopic** lens for my camera so I can photograph objects at a distance," said Charles. "But most of all, I want lunch! There's a snack bar with a **microwave** oven. Let's eat!"



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Use Words in Context

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Directions Imagine that you are a museum guide being interviewed for a newspaper article. You've been asked the following questions. Use a vocabulary word to answer each question. The clue for which vocabulary word to use is printed in boldface. Write your answer on the line.

1. Some pieces of pottery have been broken into **small, almost invisible** pieces. Does it take a lot of work to put all these very tiny pieces back together again?

   _____

2. Does your museum have an early example of an instrument that a submarine captain uses **to view objects on the water**?

   _____

3. Do most artists sign their work in a **flowing script** or in bold print?

   _____

4. Do the mummies show that the ancient Egyptians believed in the possibility of **living forever**?

   _____

5. Is the looting of an ancient burial place a rare or a commonplace **event**?

   _____

6. What did the ancient Egyptian kings do that shows that they refused to accept the **certainty of their death**?

   _____

7. Do any exhibits show warriors wearing armor to protect themselves against **deadly** wounds?

   _____

8. In what **course of study** would the Egyptian exhibit be useful?

   _____

Write New Questions Make a list of the seven vocabulary words that you did not use in the activity above. Write three more interview questions using one of those seven vocabulary words in each question.

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Review and Extend

curriculum	**immortal**	**microscopic**	**mortality**	**recurring**
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New Words

cursor **mortality** **microbiology** **cursory** **microbe** **stereoscope**

Directions Use your knowledge of word roots to fill in the blank in each sentence below.

1. If you write in **cursive**, you write in a _____ (*flowing, shaky, broken*) script and the letters run together.
2. If you take a **cursory** glance at something, you look at it _____ (*carefully, slowly, quickly*), almost as though it is unimportant.
3. The **cursor** on a computer is _____ (*fixed, moveable, playful*) so that you can place it where you want to add or change a letter.
4. All living things are **mortal** and so they eventually _____ (*die, continue, renew*).
5. Smoking cigarettes can cause a high **mortality** rate because cigarettes can make people _____ (*slightly, deathly, never*) ill.
6. Kids often enjoy looking into a **kaleidoscope** and viewing the many _____ (*changing, stable, dull*) colors and patterns.
7. A **stereoscope** is an instrument for _____ (*listening to, finding, viewing*) objects that uses two lenses to create a three-dimensional effect.
8. If something is **microscopic**, you can _____ (*barely, clearly, never*) see it.
9. A **microbe** is a very _____ (*large, dead, small*) life form that may cause a disease.
10. If you read a book about **microbiology**, you might read about _____ (*bears, turtles, bacteria*).

Create a Superhero Use vocabulary words to describe a superhero you might create for a comic book. For example, you might give your hero *telescopic* vision and a neck like a *periscope*. Include at least four vocabulary words. If you like, coin new words using the roots in this lesson. For example, a *malscope* or *villainscope* might help the superhero identify evildoers.

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Check Your Mastery

Directions Circle the letter that best completes each item below.

1. If scientists are studying **microscopic** things, they might be studying _____.
A. clothing styles **B.** dinosaurs **C.** germs **D.** lions

2. The best reason to use a **microwave** oven is to _____.
A. save time **C.** do what your friends do
B. be up to date **D.** cook something slowly

3. The person who is most likely to use a **periscope** is _____.
A. an airplane pilot **B.** a mail carrier **C.** a submarine captain **D.** a doctor

4. If you own a cat, all of the following might be **recurring** problems EXCEPT that it _____.
A. ran away once and then never again **C.** fails to use the litter box
B. scratches your friends **D.** claws the furniture

5. A **mortal** injury will _____.
A. make you feel better **C.** cause you to die
B. help you grow taller **D.** cause you to live forever

Directions Circle the letter of the choice that best fits in each sentence below.

6. My aunt took me on a(n) _____ to the zoo.
A. excursion **B.** curriculum **C.** occurrence

7. Because I had a bad cough, the nurse listened to my chest with a _____.
A. kaleidoscope **B.** telescopic **C.** stethoscope

8. As part of our history _____, we are studying the Revolutionary War.
A. curriculum **B.** cursive **C.** mortality

9. Some people hope to achieve _____ by writing something of lasting worth.
A. immortal **B.** mortality **C.** immortality

10. You may find the letter difficult to read because the writer wrote in _____ with a very flowery script.
A. cursive **B.** recurring **C.** occurrence

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